

Newly-wired?

Some of you might think the time for this little book came and went a while ago; on the other hand, we know there are many of you who will appreciate the following eight chapters, which cover most of what you need to know if you're new to the Internet.

Section I talks about the Internet in general, and Section II about software you use when you're connected. In Section I, then, we talk about how to choose an Internet Service Provider, what plan to choose, what settings to change on your computer, and so on. The next chapter talks about how the Internet works, for those of you who are wondering.

Following that are descriptions and mini-reviews of the most common (and essential) software you'll be using when online, most notably the Internet browser.

Communication software spans three categories, though we haven't put them in a single chapter: Instant Messengers, VoIP software (using which you can talk to people using a computer instead of a telephone), and e-mail clients. RSS readers are in a category of their own; for those who don't know, they're the current way of keeping in touch with the news as it appears on the Internet.

Rounding it off is a chapter on security. For some of you, it might seem like we've been talking about it too much; we should say that one can never talk too much about security, especially to people just recently online (or getting online right now)!

It's a little difficult for most people when they begin to use the Internet for the first time—everything can seem confusing, and not everything makes sense. Things ease up very soon, however, and one gets the hang of it rather quickly. This book is to ease those initial pains—if you have a good idea of the basics, and of the software you're using, that's half the job done!